

How to keep the records

Best practice for the 15 sheets: what to do, who does it, what not to do, and why.

These sheets are not paperwork for its own sake. They are the **evidence that the work was done**: the fridge was checked, the chicken reached temperature, the delivery was refused when it arrived warm. A record is only worth anything if someone reading it later can trust it. Everything in this guide is about making your records trustworthy.

The six rules

1. **Keep the sheet where the reading is taken.** A log kept in the office gets filled in from memory at the end of the week, and that is the pattern an inspector recognises fastest.
2. **Write it at the time, with the real time.** “08:00” every single morning is not believable. “07:52”, “08:14” and “08:05” are.
3. **Write what you saw, not what it should be.** An out-of-limit reading with an action beside it proves the system works. A perfect column of 3°C proves nothing.
4. **Every breach gets an action.** If a reading is outside the limit, the same line says what you did, and Sheet 13 says how you will stop it happening again.
5. **Someone senior reviews every sheet, every week.** Sign the “Checked by manager” box with a name and date. A log nobody reviews is a log nobody trusts.
6. **Calibrate first.** If your probe is wrong, every temperature on every sheet is wrong. Sheet 05 comes before everything else.

CORRECTING A MISTAKE

Strike through the wrong entry with **one single line** so it can still be read, write the correct entry beside it, and initial and date the change. **Never** use correction fluid, overwrite numbers, or tear out and rewrite a sheet. A visible correction is normal. A hidden one looks like falsification.

REG AND OPS, THE TAG ON EVERY SHEET

REG: a regulatory reference, believed to derive from the FSS Act 2006 or Schedule 4 of the 2011 Regulations, cited so you can check it. **OPS**: The Pass’s own working rule, drawn from UK kitchen practice, with no regulatory claim. It is stricter than required in places, on purpose. Keeping these sheets does not make a kitchen compliant and certifies nothing.

Who does what

Put a name, not a job title, against each sheet on your rota. "The kitchen" doesn't fill in logs. People do.

Owner / licence holder	Accountable for the whole system. Books the things a template can't give you: water test, pest contract, FoSTaC training, canopy deep-clean. Keeps Sheets 07, 11, 14 and 15. Reviews Sheet 13 monthly for patterns.
Head chef / kitchen manager	Runs the system day to day. Owns calibration (05), cooling (04) and the allergen matrix (12). Signs the weekly review on every kitchen sheet.
Shift lead / sous chef	Makes sure the readings happen during the shift. Checks cooking (02) and hot holding (03) at the end of service. Logs pest sightings (09) and breaches (13).
Line cooks	Fill in the readings for the food they cook: cold storage at opening and close (01), cooking (02), hot holding (03), cooling (04).
Storekeeper / receiver	Checks and logs every delivery (06), including the rejections. Records oil collections (14).
Closing person, per area	Signs the cleaning schedule (08) for tasks actually done that day.
Front-of-house manager	Knows where the allergen matrix (12) is and uses it. Never guesses for a guest.
Manager, privately	Holds the return-to-work conversation and keeps the fitness-to-work log (10) confidential.

The weekly review: what the checker looks for

- **Gaps.** Missing days or shifts, and blank rows filled in later.
- **Numbers that are too perfect.** The same reading every day, or every time rounded to :00.
- **Same pen, same hand.** A week of entries that look like they were written in one sitting.
- **Breaches without actions.** Every out-of-limit reading should have a line on Sheet 13.
- **Probe IDs.** Readings taken with a probe that failed calibration that week.
- **Dates running out.** Supplier licences, water test, medical exams and the pest contract due soon.

Then sign and date the "Checked by manager" box. If you find a problem, raise it with the person that day. The review is for fixing the system, not for blaming whoever wrote the entry.

Sheet by sheet

01 Cold Storage Temperature Log

REG

WHEN

Twice daily: at opening and at close, for every fridge and freezer.

WHO CHECKS IT

Head chef, signed weekly.

WHO FILLS IT

The opening chef and the closing chef, named on the rota.

WHERE IT LIVES

Clipped to or beside each fridge bank.

DO

- Probe a food item, or a probe kept in a sealed pot of water inside the unit.
- Write the actual number, e.g. 3.8, not a tick or "OK".
- If a unit is over 5°C, move the high-risk food, recheck in 30 minutes, and log it on Sheet 13.

DON'T

- Read the door display. It measures the air near the door, not the food at the back.
- Fill in the opening reading at close, or the whole week at once.

WHY IT MATTERS This is the record most often asked for. A column of identical readings is the quickest sign that a log was written from memory.

02 Cooking & Reheating Temperature Log

OPS

WHEN

Every batch of high-risk food: meat, poultry, seafood, eggs, rice, dairy-based gravies and anything cooked ahead.

WHO CHECKS IT

Sous chef or head chef, at the end of each service.

WHO FILLS IT

The cook who cooked the batch.

WHERE IT LIVES

On the cooking line, at the pass.

DO

- Probe the thickest part, away from bone. Aim for a core of 75°C or above.
- Wipe and sanitise the probe between foods.
- Reheat once only, to 75°C or above, and write the reading.

DON'T

- Judge doneness by colour, bubbling or time on the flame.
- Reheat anything a second time. What comes back twice is thrown away.

WHY IT MATTERS Cooking is the step that kills bacteria. The core reading is the only proof that it happened.

03 Hot Holding Log

REG

WHEN

Every two hours during service, for everything held hot: bain-marie, handi, buffet.

WHO CHECKS IT

Shift lead, at the end of service.

WHO FILLS IT

Whoever is running the counter or hot section.

WHERE IT LIVES

At the hot-holding station.

DO

- Stir, then probe the food itself. Keep it at 60°C or above.
- If it has dropped below 60°C, throw it away, and write down that you did.

DON'T

- Rely on the bain-marie dial or the flame setting.
- Reheat food that has sat below the limit and put it back out.

WHY IT MATTERS Warm food, between chilled and hot, is where bacteria grow fastest. The discard entry is what an inspector looks for, because it shows the limit is real.

04 Cooling & Chill-Down Log

OPS

WHEN

Every batch cooked now and served later: rice, gravies, stocks, dals.

WHO CHECKS IT

Head chef, the next morning.

WHO FILLS IT

The cook who made the batch.

WHERE IT LIVES

Beside the blast chiller or the main walk-in.

DO

- Portion into shallow trays, spread thin and leave uncovered to cool.
- Record the start time and temperature, then the reading at 90 minutes. The target is 4°C or below.

DON'T

- Put a deep, covered pot of hot food straight into the fridge. The centre stays warm for hours and warms everything around it.
- Leave batches on the counter overnight to cool.

WHY IT MATTERS Cooked rice and thick gravies that cool slowly are one of the most common causes of food poisoning in commercial kitchens.

05 Thermometer Calibration Log

OPS

WHEN

Weekly, and whenever a probe is dropped or gives an odd reading.

WHO CHECKS IT

Owner or general manager, monthly.

WHO FILLS IT

Head chef or one named person.

WHERE IT LIVES

Kitchen office, with the probes.

DO

- Number every probe so the readings on every other sheet can be traced back to a probe.
- Test in iced water (0°C) and boiling water (100°C). Both must be within $\pm 1^\circ\text{C}$.
- Do this first, before you start any other sheet.

DON'T

- Keep using a probe that fails. Take it out of service the same day.
- Share unnumbered probes between sections.

WHY IT MATTERS This is the sheet that makes all the others true. A probe reading 3 degrees warm turns a month of honest records into fiction, and nobody can tell by looking.

06 Goods Receiving Log

OPS

WHEN

Every delivery, before the driver leaves.

WHO CHECKS IT

Head chef, weekly.

WHO FILLS IT

Whoever receives the goods: storekeeper or receiving chef, trained and holding a probe.

WHERE IT LIVES

At the receiving door.

DO

- Probe chilled and frozen goods between packs. Check packaging, use-by dates and the vehicle.
- Reject chilled goods at 8°C or above and frozen goods at -12°C or above. Write the reason and tell the supplier.

DON'T

- Sign the delivery note before checking.
- Let goods be left at the door unchecked, or accept "we'll fix it next time".

WHY IT MATTERS Once you sign for it, the supplier's problem becomes yours. A year with no rejections at all reads like a log nobody filled in.

07 Approved Supplier List

REG

WHEN

Reviewed once a year, and every time you add a supplier.

WHO CHECKS IT

Owner.

WHO FILLS IT

Owner or purchase manager.

WHERE IT LIVES

Office file.

DO

- Hold every supplier's FSSAI licence number and its expiry date.
- Put renewal dates in the calendar.

DON'T

- Add an ad-hoc cash-and-carry supplier without recording them.
- Let a licence lapse unnoticed.

WHY IT MATTERS Buying from an unlicensed supplier makes their problem your problem. Ask for the licence once, note the expiry, and it never comes up again.

08 Daily Cleaning Schedule & Sign-Off

REG

WHEN

Daily, signed by whoever closes each area.

WHO CHECKS IT

Head chef or manager, the next morning.

WHO FILLS IT

The closing person for each section.

WHERE IT LIVES

On the kitchen wall, near the wash area.

DO

- Write the chemical and its contact time against each task.
- Sign only the tasks that were actually done, on the day they were done.

DON'T

- Sign the whole week on Sunday.
- Write "wipe down". That isn't a method.

WHY IT MATTERS Sanitiser left for 30 seconds when it needs 5 minutes has not sanitised anything. The contact time is what makes the task real.

09 Pest Sighting & Action Log

REG

WHEN

The same day as any sighting or sign.

WHO CHECKS IT

Manager. Show it to your pest contractor at every visit.

WHO FILLS IT

Anyone who sees a sign tells the shift lead, who logs it.

WHERE IT LIVES

Kitchen office.

DO

- Log signs, not just animals: droppings, gnaw marks, smear marks, nesting.
- Record where, what, the action taken, and whether the contractor was called.

DON'T

- Clean up droppings without logging them and finding the way in.
- Make staff feel blamed for reporting. You want every sighting.

WHY IT MATTERS Droppings mean a way in and a food source, and both are still there until someone finds them. This is your own log, and it doesn't replace the contractor's service reports.

10 Staff Fitness-to-Work Log

OPS

WHEN

Every return to work after vomiting, diarrhoea, fever or an infected wound.

WHO CHECKS IT

Owner.

WHO FILLS IT

Manager only, in a private conversation.

WHERE IT LIVES

Confidential file. Never on the wall.

DO

- Record the return-to-work conversation and the date the person was cleared. Use a role or reference, not a full name.
- Keep the person away from food handling until 48 hours after their last symptom.

DON'T

- Write down diagnoses or medical detail.
- Make reporting costly. If being ill means losing a shift, people hide it.

WHY IT MATTERS This protects your staff as much as your guests. It only works if people feel safe telling you.

11 Staff Training & Medical Register

REG

WHEN

On hire, then every year.

WHO CHECKS IT

Owner.

WHO FILLS IT

Owner or manager.

WHERE IT LIVES

Confidential office file.

DO

- Record food-safety training and the medical exam date for every food handler, and when each is next due.
- Keep at least one FoSTaC-certified supervisor for every 25 food handlers.

DON'T

- Count a certificate held by someone who has left.
- Pin it up. It holds personal information.

WHY IT MATTERS FoSTaC certification comes from an FSSAI-empanelled training partner. This sheet records who holds it; it doesn't replace it.

12 Master Allergen Matrix

REG

WHEN

Every time a menu item or recipe changes.

WHO CHECKS IT

Owner, at every menu change.

WHO FILLS IT

Head chef writes it. The front-of-house manager must know where it is.

WHERE IT LIVES

At the pass, and at the front-of-house station.

DO

- Work from the recipes, including sauces, marinades, oils, garnishes and ghee (milk).
- Date and version every update. Check the declarable list against current FSSAI labelling rules.

DON'T

- Change a dish without updating the matrix.
- Guess from dish names, or let staff tell a guest "it should be fine".

WHY IT MATTERS A matrix that is out of date is dangerous precisely because it still looks complete.

13 Corrective Action Log

OPS

WHEN

Whenever any limit on any sheet is breached.

WHO CHECKS IT

Head chef weekly. Owner monthly, looking for patterns.

WHO FILLS IT

Whoever found it, with the shift lead.

WHERE IT LIVES

Kitchen office, next to the other logs.

DO

- Record what went wrong, what you did with the food, and what will stop it happening again.
- Reference the control, e.g. CS.1, so the link to the other sheet is clear.

DON'T

- Log a breach with no action beside it.
- Leave this sheet empty for months. Real kitchens have breaches.

WHY IT MATTERS A log full of breaches with no actions is worse than no log: it is a written record that you knew and did nothing. A breach with an action is proof the system works.

14 Used Cooking Oil Disposal Log

REG

WHEN

Every collection.

WHO CHECKS IT

Owner, monthly.

WHO FILLS IT

Storekeeper or manager.

WHERE IT LIVES

Office file, with the collector's receipts.

DO

- Hand used oil only to a registered collector. Record the quantity and their registration number.
- Staple the collector's receipt to the sheet.

DON'T

- Sell or give used oil to an unregistered buyer.

WHY IT MATTERS The log says the oil left. The receipt says where it went. You need both.

15 Water, Ice & Tank Records

REG

WHEN

Potable water test yearly. Tank clean every six months.

WHO CHECKS IT

Owner.

WHO FILLS IT

Owner or manager books the laboratory and the cleaner.

WHERE IT LIVES

Office file, with the certificates.

DO

- Test with a recognised laboratory and file the certificate.
- Note the next due date the day the result arrives.

DON'T

- Assume municipal supply or an RO unit means no test is needed.
- Lose the certificate. Without it, the test didn't happen.

WHY IT MATTERS This is routinely the first document asked for, and routinely the one that is missing.

What not to do

These are the patterns that make an inspector stop trusting a whole folder, not just one sheet.

Filling in logs at the end of the week	Entries written from memory are identical, round and in the same pen, and that is visible at a glance.
Pre-filling dates or times	It shows the sheet was prepared before the work was done.
Writing “OK” or ✓ instead of a number	It records an opinion, not a measurement.
Reading the door display	It shows the air near the door, not the food. Always probe.
Correction fluid or overwriting	A hidden correction looks like falsification. Use one line, initial and date.
A year with no breaches or rejections	Real kitchens have them. A spotless record reads as an unfilled one.
No one signing “Checked by manager”	It tells a reader that nobody is watching the system.
Personal or medical details on the wall	Sheets 10 and 11 belong in a confidential file.

Your first week

- Day 1.** Number your probes and calibrate them (Sheet 05). Replace any that fail.
- Day 1.** Print the sheets and put each one where its reading is taken. Put a name against each on the rota.
- Day 2.** Walk your team through the six rules on page 1. It takes ten minutes, standing at the fridge.
- This week.** Start the supplier list (07) and ask each supplier for their FSSAI licence number.
- This month.** Check the four things a template can't give you: a water test certificate from the last 12 months, a FoSTaC supervisor, a pest control contract, and a canopy deep-clean certificate. Book whatever is missing.
- Every week.** Hold a fixed review slot. Our working default is to keep completed sheets filed by month for at least a year. Check whether your licence conditions ask for longer.

WHEN YOU WANT TO KNOW IT'S WORKING

The Pass is an unannounced 90-minute kitchen standards review in Kolkata. We walk your kitchen in the order food moves, against 63 written controls, check these records against what we see, and give you a report in 72 hours.

[KUROKAA.COM/THE-PASS](https://kurokaa.com/the-pass)

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